ETHAN OLVERA

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Portfolio: https://sites.google.com/view/ejrolvera/home | GitHub: github.com/TheRealET06

EDUCATION

Northern Illinois University — DeKalb, IL
Bachelor of Science – Computer Science | Expected Graduation: Spring 2027 | GPA: 4.0

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Technical: Microsoft Excel (Intermediate), Python, C++, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Unreal Engine, DaVinci Resolve
Product: AI Software Development, Virtual Production, Workflow Optimization, Software Auditing, System Development
Analytical: Strategic Planning, Troubleshooting, Risk Assessment, Decision-Making
Soft Skills: Project Leadership, Mentorship, Public Speaking, Team Collaboration, Adaptability, Ownership
Tools & Platforms: Git, DaVinci Resolve, Excel, Basic Networking, Web & Email System Administration
Creative / Media: Video Editing, Digital Content Production, Social Media Management

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

XR Virtual Production Pipeline – NIU Studio

- Developed mixed-reality capture workflow integrating LIV.tv with Unreal Engine for real-time XR compositing.
- Configured camera inputs, rendering settings, and capture systems to produce immersive XR media.

Hackathon Software Prototypes

- Collaborated on rapid-development teams building working prototypes within 24–48 hour hackathon environments.
- Applied iterative development and debugging to deliver functional project demos under strict time constraints.

EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Researcher – Virtual Production / XR
Northern Illinois University Office of Innovation | DeKalb, IL | September 2025 – Present

- Led the development of NIU's virtual production studio, enabling XR research and immersive storytelling, demonstrating early engagement with AI-related technologies.
- Built and operated LIV.tv workflows for real-time mixed-reality capture, focusing on practical systems development and operational efficiency.
- Utilized Unreal Engine virtual production tools to create immersive XR content for enterprise application.
- Prototype and test new XR workflows and studio technologies, analyzing results to improve performance and usability.
- Collaborate with cross-disciplinary teams to explore interactive and immersive storytelling techniques using real-time engines.

Student Program Development Lead
Northern Illinois University Office of Innovation | DeKalb, IL | September 2025 – December 2025

- Directed the creation and development of NIU's Computer Science Hackathon Team, embodying an entrepreneurial approach.
- Applied analytical thinking and effective decision-making to develop innovative, high-quality hackathon solutions.
- Led teams competing in national and international hackathons, achieving strong performance under tight deadlines.
- Mentored students in collaborative development, experimentation, and solution design.

System & Web Administrator (Volunteer)
American Legion Illinois Premier Boys State | Charleston, IL | June 2025 – Present

- Oversaw daily operations and troubleshooting of email systems and websites, contributing to organizational operational efficiency.
- Diagnose and resolve technical issues impacting system performance and reliability.
- Collaborate with a media and operations team to deploy digital platforms and communication tools for program participants.
- Develop and manage web and media content supporting outreach and program engagement.

Honors Fellow
Northern Illinois University Honors Program | DeKalb, IL | July 2025 – Present

- Mentored 30 honors freshmen through academic transitions, showcasing leadership and interpersonal communication.
- Selected for exceptional leadership, mentorship, and academic distinction.

Sports Official – Baseball, Football & Basketball
Fox Valley Officials Association / IHSA | Elgin, IL | February 2024 – Present

- Managed complex game flows requiring independent decision-making and rule enforcement under pressure.
- Enforce regulations, resolve rule infractions, and maintain professionalism to command respect from players and coaches.